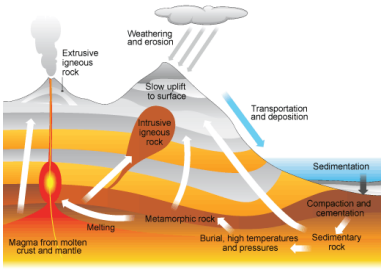
Rock Cycle



Replace the punctuation in the following paragraphs:

The Rock Cycle

Rising magma can escape through cracks in the Earth’s crust. It cools and solidifies, creating new igneous rock. This new rock is exposed to the forces of weathering, which break it down into smaller rocks. These are in turn eroded by wind and water, and deposited some distance from its parent rock.

Sediments of eroded rock build up over tens of thousands of years and form layers. The lower layers of sediments are compressed and squeezed under increasing pressure to form sedimentary rock. Deep sedimentary layers are subjected to extreme heat and are changed into metamorphic rock, or are thrust up onto the surface to be weathered again.

Metamorphic rock can be thrust up onto the surface of the Earth to be weathered, or pushed lower to melt and become magma and start the cycle of rock formation again. This cycle of pressure, heat, cooling and weathering is called the rock cycle.

Questions:

1. What type of rock is formed from solidified magma? _____

2. What happens to sediments to form sedimentary rock? _____

   _____

3. What two things can happen to metamorphic rock? _____

   _____